

VERBAL APTITUDE

LEC-13

VOCABULARY

- Vocabulary ✓✓
- Tumbled and Parajumbled ✓
- Synonyms and Antonyms ✓
- Idioms and Phrases ✓

Vocabulary

- Daily newspaper (english)
- Books
- Movies

- world Power mode easy
- Dictionary
- GRE Barron Rth edition
 - ↳ 3000 High Frequency
- ~~★~~ Chamber's Thesaurus

डॉटना

- Scold (informal)
- Reprimand
- Castigate
- Admonish

Silhouette

↳ Shadow

Root word



ASHUTOSH SAXENA SIR

- 14+ Year's Teaching Experience
- M.Tech from IIT BHU (2010)
- Books Written
- Engineering Ethics, Power System
- **Area of Expertise:** Power System, Electrical Machines, Electromagnetic Field Theory, Material Science, Engineering Ethics, Measurement Verbal Aptitude



ASHUTOSH SIR



TCS NQT

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1- Use Context First Rule (MOST IMPORTANT ★)

Never decide the meaning of a word in isolation.

Ask:

Is the sentence positive or negative?

Is the word showing praise, criticism, intensity, or neutrality?

Example

The judge was lenient with the offender.

Context → punishment → lenient = not strict

soft

someone who did
offence

2- Identify Part of Speech

Check whether the word is:

Noun

Verb

Adjective

Adverb



Wrong options often belong to the wrong part of speech.

3- Look for Context Clues

Clues may appear as:

Synonyms

Antonyms

Examples

Cause-effect indicators

Signal words:

but, however, although (contrast)

because, therefore (cause/effect)

Antonyms

✓✓ Easy — Difficult

Agile — Inactive

(super active) Lethargic

Lazy

4- Apply Prefix-Root-Suffix Rule

Break unfamiliar words into parts.

Prefix → Before
 Suffix → After

Prefix		Meaning
anti	✓	against ✓
bene	✓	good ✓
mal	✓	bad ✓
pre	✓	before ✓
post	✓	after ✓

posterior (after)

Acrophobia - fear of heights

Suffix	Meaning
-ology	study of
-phobia	fear
-less	without

Example

Benevolent → bene (good) + volent (wishing) → kind

↓
being kind to others.

Theology (ईश्वरवाद)

↓
Study of God

Claustrophobia
fear of closed spaces

5- Eliminate Extreme Options

Words like:

always, never, completely, entirely

are often incorrect, unless context clearly supports them.

6- Beware of Confusing Word Pairs

Frequently tested traps:

Word	Meaning
Affect	influence (verb)
Effect	result (noun)
Eminent	famous
Imminent	about to happen
Accept	receive
Except	exclude

verb → influence
noun

7- ROOTS RELATED TO LIFE, HUMAN & MIND

Biology

Root	Meaning	Examples
bio	life	biology, biography
psycho	mind	psychology, psychotic
anthrop	human	anthropology, misanthrope
dem	people	democracy, epidemic
anim	life/soul	animate, animation
ego	self	egoist, egotism

Gandhi Ji'a

The story of my experiments with truth

Biography
Autobiography



Ego

↳ self

Egoist

who prefers own
interest before other's

↓
not
Selfish

Altruist

→ who prefers other's
interest first.

Chickenpox

→ Smallpox ✓
 ○ मटर ✓

epidemic spreading

↳ a widely (disease)
in a specific

pandemic → Covid-19

↳ covering
large
area

Misanthrope

hate human

Sycophant

चिपचुप

8- ROOTS RELATED TO STUDY, KNOWLEDGE & THINKING

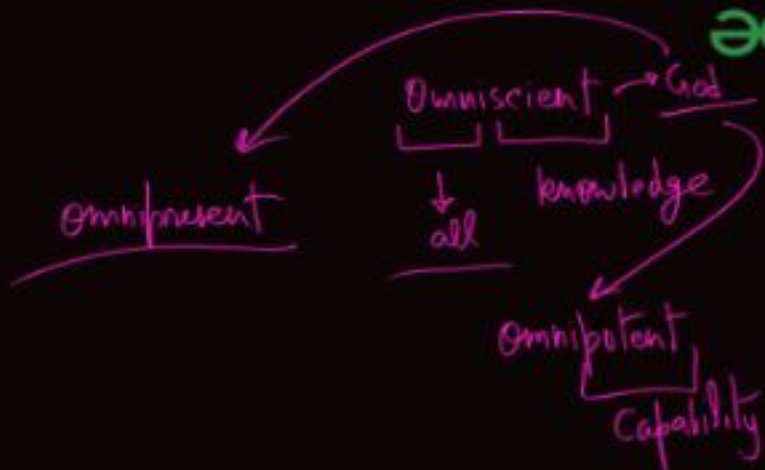
Root	Meaning	Examples
log / logy	study, word	biology, logic
gnosis	knowledge	diagnosis, prognosis
soph	wisdom	philosophy, sophisticated
scient	knowledge	science, omniscient
cogn	know	cognition, recognize

brain

Cognition

philosophy

 ↓ love knowledge/wisdom





Diagnosis → To find the root cause of
Prognosis → future course of disease

9- ROOTS RELATED TO SPEAKING & COMMUNICATION

Root	Meaning	Examples
dict ✓	say ✓	dictate, verdict ✓
loqu ✓	speak ✓	eloquent, soliloquy ✓
voc ✓	voice ✓	vocal, vocation ✓
narr ✓	tell ✓	narrate, narrative ✓
scrib / script ✓	write ✓	describe, manuscript ✓

one actor

Soliloquy

monologue

Drama

10- ROOTS RELATED TO SEEING & PERCEPTION

Root	Meaning	Examples
vis / vid	see	vision, evident
spect	look	inspect, perspective
optic	eye	optical, optician
scop	watch	microscope, telescope

tele → far

11- ROOTS RELATED TO MOVEMENT & DIRECTION

Root	Meaning	Examples
mot / mov	move	motion, promote
grad / gress	step	progress, gradual
port	carry	transport, export
ped	foot	pedestrian, impede
vert	turn	reverse, convert

overthink

Centipede

Hundred

foot

prevent

↓
गार्दी सोच



12- ROOTS RELATED TO TIME & ORDER

Root	Meaning	Examples
chron	time	chronology, chronic
temp	time	temporary, temporal
prim	first	primary, primitive
post	after	postpone, postwar
pre	before	predict, preview

Chronic
↑
Long time

Primitive Island

Aboriginal

सबसे पहले

13- ROOTS RELATED TO POWER, FORCE & CONTROL

Root	Meaning	Examples
dyn	power	dynamic, dynamite
potent	powerful	potent, omnipotent
domin	rule	dominate, domain
arch	chief	architect, monarchy
tyr	ruler	tyrant, tyranny

Democracy

राजतन्त्र

people → king

→ Rule

Aristocracy

राजा का
बेटा
राजा

Monarchy

↓
राजा का शासन

king's rule

14- ROOTS RELATED TO GOOD & BAD

Root	Meaning	Examples
bene	good	benefit, benevolent
mal	bad	malfunction, malicious
eu	good/well	euphoria, euthanasia
mis	wrong	mistake, misjudge
noc	harm	innocent, noxious

eulogy - Praise

15- ROOTS RELATED TO SIZE, NUMBER & MEASURE

Root	Meaning	Examples
magn	large	magnify, magnitude
mini	small	miniature, minimal
multi	many	multiple, multiply
uni	one	uniform, unilateral
poly	many	polygon, polyglot

Zen ← Japan → Miniaturization

Zen-Buddhism

Polygamy



Polyandry



Polyglot

± one who can
speak many
languages

16- ROOTS RELATED TO FEELINGS & EMOTIONS

Root	Meaning	Examples
path	feeling	sympathy, <u>apathy</u>
phil	love	philosophy, philanthropist
phob	fear	phobia, claustrophobia
irasc	anger	<u>irascible</u>

to dislike

Indifferent
Detest

डिप्ट



philanthropist

large donation

GTW

17- ROOTS RELATED TO NATURE & SCIENCE

Root	Meaning	Examples
geo	earth	geography, geology
hydro	water	hydrogen, hydrology
therma	heat	thermometer, thermal
astro	star	astronomy, astronaut
aero	air	aerospace, aerobic

18- ROOTS RELATED TO FORM & STRUCTURE

Root	Meaning	Examples
form	shape	reform, transform
struct	build	construct, structure
morph	form	morphology, amorphous
typ	model	prototype, typical

does not
have a fixed
shape

Science of shapes

19- ROOTS RELATED TO LAW, GOVERNANCE & SOCIETY

Root	Meaning	Examples
jur ✓	law ✓	justice, jurisdiction
cv ✓	citizen ✓	civil, civilization
polit ✓	state ✓	politics, policy
leg ✓	law	legal, legislature

20- HOW TO USE ROOT WORDS IN EXAM

- Break the word
- Identify root meaning
- Check prefix/suffix
- Match with sentence context

Example:

"Indefatigable"

in (not) + de (away) + fatig (tired) → never tired

VERBAL APTITUDE

fixed
fixed

JUMBLED AND PARAJUMBLED



General

Specific

analyse

Conclude

Therefore, Because
However, Hence,
Although
But

1- Identify the Opening Sentence (Starter Rule)

The first sentence:

✗ Usually does NOT start with:

But, However, Therefore, Thus, Hence, Although

✓ Usually introduces:

A topic ✓

A definition ✓

A general statement ✓

A time reference ✓

✓ Example

"In recent years, artificial intelligence has transformed many industries."

→ This is a strong opener (introduces topic + time).

2- Find the Closing Sentence (Conclusion Rule)

The last sentence:

Often contains:

Summary

Result / impact

Future implication

Common words:

Therefore, Thus, Hence, As a result, Finally

✓ Example

"Thus, ethical regulation of AI is essential for sustainable growth."

3- Look for Mandatory Pairs (Most Important Rule ★)

Some sentences must come together.

• Pronoun Rule

If a sentence contains:

he, she, it, they, this, these, such

→ The sentence must come after the noun it refers to.

✓ Example

A. "The smartphone has changed communication."

B. "It has become an essential tool."

→ Correct order: A → B

Ravi is very good in
his class.

He learns sincerely

4- Use Connector & Transition Words

Words indicate direction of flow:

Connector	Meaning
However	Contrast
Therefore / Thus	Result
Moreover / Also	Addition
For example	Illustration
Although	Contrast (starter clause)

5- Follow Logical Sequence of Ideas

Most paragraphs follow one of these flows:

✦ Common Patterns

General → Specific ✓

Problem → Cause → Solution

Cause → Effect

Past → Present → Future

Claim → Explanation → Example

✓ Example

Problem → impact → solution

6- Observe Tense Consistency

Past tense → events

Present tense → facts

Future tense → consequences

→ Sentences with future tense often come at the end.

7- Check Chronological Order

If dates or time words exist:



Initially, later, eventually, finally

→ Arrange according to time.

B- Watch for Definite Articles (the, this, that)

A sentence starting with "the" usually refers to something already mentioned.

So it rarely starts a paragraph.

9- Use Elimination Method



If unsure:

Eliminate options where:

Pronouns appear before nouns

Connectors appear without context

Compare remaining options logically.

10- Title Matching Rule (Advanced)

If a title is given:

First sentence should align closely with the title

Entire paragraph should revolve around it

11- QUICK STRATEGY (EXAM READY)

- Find starter sentence
- Identify mandatory pairs
- Detect connectors
- Arrange middle sentences logically
- Fix ending sentence

QUESTION 1

B/C

A^x D^x

- A. As a result, renewable energy is gaining global attention.
- B. Fossil fuels are rapidly depleting worldwide.
- C. Governments are investing heavily in solar and wind power.
- D. This shift is necessary to ensure long-term energy security.

C D

B D

A D



A) $B \rightarrow A \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$

B) $B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A \rightarrow D$

C) ~~A~~ $\rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$

D) $B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D \rightarrow A$

☒ Correct Answer: B

Reasoning:

B introduces the problem (fossil fuel depletion)

C shows action taken

A gives result

D concludes with purpose

✓ Logical flow: Problem → Action → Result → Conclusion

QUESTION 2

B C A D
A' C' D'

- A. However, excessive screen time can negatively affect mental health.
- B. Smartphones have become an integral part of modern life.
- C. Many people rely on them for work, communication, and entertainment.
- D. Therefore, balanced usage is essential.

BC

A) ~~B~~ → A → C → D

B) B → C → A → D

C) A → B → C → D

D) B → C → D → A

 Correct Answer: B

Reasoning:

B introduces topic

C explains usage

A contrasts using "However"

D gives conclusion using "Therefore"

QUESTION 3

B C D A
A^x C^x D^x

- A. This discovery changed the course of modern physics.
B. In 1905, Albert Einstein published several groundbreaking papers.
C. One of them introduced the theory of relativity.
D. It challenged existing notions of space and time.

CD

A) $B \rightarrow A \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$

B) $B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D \rightarrow A$ ✓

C) $C \rightarrow B \rightarrow D \rightarrow A$

D) $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$

✓ Correct Answer: B

Reasoning:

B introduces time + person

C specifies "one of them"

D explains impact

A concludes

QUESTION 4

- A. These skills are crucial in today's competitive job market.
- B. Education helps individuals develop critical thinking skills.
- C. It also promotes creativity and problem-solving abilities.
- D. As a result, education plays a vital role in personal growth.

BC

BACD

B A C D
A' C' B'

A) $B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A \rightarrow D$

B) $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$

C) $B \rightarrow A \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$

D) $B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D \rightarrow A$

Correct Answer:

~~A~~ C

Reasoning:

B introduces education

C adds more skills

A explains importance

D gives result

QUESTION 5

- A. Consequently, urban flooding has become a frequent problem.
- B. Many cities lack proper drainage systems.
- C. Heavy rainfall overwhelms existing infrastructure.
- D. This issue requires immediate planning and investment.

B C A D
A' D'



BD

BC

A) $B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A \rightarrow D$ ✓

B) $C \rightarrow B \rightarrow A \rightarrow D$

C) $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$

D) $B \rightarrow A \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$

✓ Correct Answer: A

Reasoning:

B root cause

C trigger

A consequence

D solution statement

QUESTION 6

B A C D
A C B

A. For example, electric vehicles reduce carbon emissions significantly.

B. Sustainable practices can mitigate environmental damage.

C. They also decrease dependence on fossil fuels.

D. Hence, sustainability must be prioritized globally.

~~AC~~ AC

A) $B \rightarrow A \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$ ✓ ✓

B) $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$

C) $B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A \rightarrow D$

D) $C \rightarrow B \rightarrow A \rightarrow D$

✓ Correct Answer: A

Reasoning:

B general statement

A example

C additional benefit

D conclusion

QUESTION 7

B A D C
N C B

- A. It enables machines to learn from data and improve performance.
- B. Artificial intelligence is transforming various industries. ✓
- C. As a result, productivity and efficiency have increased.
- D. This technology is widely used in healthcare and finance.

BDX

BA

A) $B \rightarrow A \rightarrow D \rightarrow C$ ✓

B) $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow D \rightarrow C$

C) $B \rightarrow D \rightarrow A \rightarrow C$

D) $B \rightarrow A \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$

✓ Correct Answer: A

Reasoning:

B introduces A1

A explains how it works

D gives applications

C gives result

QUESTION 8

- A. Therefore, regular exercise is essential for a healthy lifestyle.
 B. Physical activity improves cardiovascular health. ✓
 C. It also helps in reducing stress and anxiety.
 D. Many studies highlight the benefits of daily exercise.

D B C A
 R C



BC / DC

D B C A

A) $D \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$

B) $B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D \rightarrow A$

C) $D \rightarrow C \rightarrow B \rightarrow A$

D) $B \rightarrow D \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$

 Correct Answer: A

Reasoning:

D evidence base

B first benefit

C additional benefit

A conclusion

QUESTION 9

A. As a result, many species face the risk of extinction.

→ B. Habitat destruction is a major threat to biodiversity.

→ C. Forests are being cleared for agriculture and urbanization.

D. This loss disrupts ecological balance.

B C D A

A* D*



Habitat

BD CD

A) $B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D \rightarrow A$

B) $C \rightarrow B \rightarrow A \rightarrow D$

C) $B \rightarrow D \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$

D) $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$

 Correct Answer: A

Reasoning:

B introduces issue

C explains cause

D effect

A final outcome

QUESTION 10

B C D A
A B C D

- A. Thus, financial literacy is crucial for economic stability.
B. Many individuals struggle with managing personal finances.
C. This leads to debt and poor investment decisions.
D. Proper financial education can prevent such issues.

A) $B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D \rightarrow A$ ✓

B) $B \rightarrow D \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$

C) $D \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$

D) $C \rightarrow B \rightarrow D \rightarrow A$

✓ Correct Answer: A

Reasoning:

B problem

C consequence

D solution

A conclusion

VERBAL APTITUDE

SYNONYM AND ANTONYM

Similar meaning

Opposite meaning

ASHUTOSH SAXENA SIR

- 14+ Year's Teaching Experience
- M.Tech from IIT BHU (2010)
- Books Written
- Engineering Ethics, Power System
- **Area of Expertise:** Power System, Electrical Machines, Electromagnetic Field Theory, Material Science, Engineering Ethics, Measurement Verbal Aptitude



ASHUTOSH SIR

Q1. Synonym of ABUNDANT is:

A) Scarce

B) Plentiful

C) Rare

D) Limited

→ available in huge quantity,
more than what is
required

Q2. Antonym of TRANSPARENT is:

- A) Clear
- B) Lucid
- C) Opaque ✓
- D) Visible

→ look through

→ clear Lucid explanation

Q3. Synonym of METICULOUS is:

A) Careless

B) Precise

C) Lazy

D) Hasty

→ one who cares about
small, small details

He is a meticulous student

Q4. Antonym of BENEVOLENT is:

- A) Kind
- B) Generous
- C) Malicious
- D) Helpful

Q5. Synonym of IMMINENT is:

- A) Past
- B) Distant
- C) Impending
- D) Delayed

about to happen

Q6. Antonym of CONCISE is:

- A) Brief
- B) Short
- C) Verbose
- D) Clear

→ Limited

Tacit → using very few words
 Taciturn → one

→ too many words

Grandiloquent

उग्र शब्दों का प्रयोग

Gregarious

सुख, पार्टी loving

Q7. Synonym of FRUGAL is:

A) Wasteful

B) Thrifty ✓

C) Lavish

D) Extravagant ✓✓

→ Spends wisely

↘ opposite

Spendthrift

Q8. Antonym of HOSTILE is:

A) Aggressive

B) Friendly ✓

C) Violent

D) Cruel

→ harmful, opposite

Q9. Synonym of CANDID is:

- A) Deceitful
- B) Honest
- C) Clever
- D) Secretive

→ as it is

candid chat

Q10. Antonym of OPTIMISTIC is

- A) Cheerful
- B) Hopeful
- C) Pessimistic ✓
- D) Confident

Q11. Synonym of RESILIENT is:

A) Fragile

B) Flexible

C) Weak

D) Delicate

→ able to handle challenges

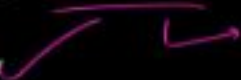
→ weak

Q12. Antonym of OBSCURE is:

- A) Hidden
- B) Vague
- C) Clear ✓
- D) Complex

↳ not clear

Q13. Synonym of ERUDITE is:

- A) Ignorant
 - B) Scholarly
 - C) Foolish
 - D) Illiterate
- 

Q14. Antonym of RIGID is:

A) Stiff

B) Hard

C) Flexible ✓

D) Solid

↳ hard

Q15. Synonym of APATHETIC is:

- A) Enthusiastic
- B) Indifferent
- C) Passionate
- D) Energetic

→ not interested

Q16. Antonym of SCARCITY is:

A) Shortage

B) Lack

C) Abundance

D) Deficiency

→ very rare



Q17. Synonym of PRUDENT is:

- A) Reckless
- B) Careless
- C) Wise ✓
- D) Rash

→ Take a wise decision

Q18. Antonym of VULNERABLE is:

- A) Weak
- B) Exposed
- C) Secure ✓
- D) Fragile

→ easy to harm

Q19. Synonym of AMBIGUOUS is:

- A) Clear
- B) Precise
- C) Vague ✓
- D) Definite

not clear

Q20. Antonym of LENIENT is

- A) Mild
- B) Gentle
- C) Strict
- D) Kind

VERBAL APTITUDE

Group of words
 ↳ specific meaning

IDIOMS AND PHRASES

ASHUTOSH SAXENA SIR

- 14+ Year's Teaching Experience
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- Books Written
- Engineering Ethics, Power System
- **Area of Expertise:** Power System, Electrical Machines, Electromagnetic Field Theory, Material Science, Engineering Ethics, Measurement Verbal Aptitude



ASHUTOSH SIR

Q1.

To "cut corners" means to:

- A) Decorate something neatly
- B) Save money by reducing quality
- C) Take a sharp turn
- D) Finish work ahead of time



✔ Answer: B — Save money by reducing quality

Explanation:

To cut corners means to do something cheaply or quickly by ignoring proper standards.

Q2.

The idiom "throw down the gauntlet" means to:

- A) Withdraw from a competition
- B) Accept defeat gracefully
- C) Issue a challenge
- D) Avoid confrontation

☒ Answer: C — Issue a challenge

Explanation:

Historically, throwing a glove signified challenging someone to a duel.

Q3.

If someone "keeps his cards close to his chest", he.

- A) Cheats in a game
- B) Is very emotional
- C) Reveals everything openly
- D) Is secretive about intentions

✔ Answer: D — Is secretive about intentions

Explanation:

This idiom comes from card games—hiding cards prevents others from knowing your strategy.

Q4.

To "bell the cat" means to:

- A) Warn someone of danger
- B) Perform a risky task
- C) Punish a wrongdoer
- D) Control a powerful enemy

☒ Answer: B — Perform a risky task

Explanation:

From a fable where no one dared to put a bell on a cat despite knowing it was necessary.

Q5.

The phrase "a flash in the pan" refers to:

- A) A sudden fire accident
- B) A short-lived success
- C) A dangerous experiment
- D) A cooking error

 Answer: B — A short-lived success

Explanation:

Something that shows quick brilliance but fails to last.

Q6.

If an issue is "swept under the carpet", it is:

- A) Cleaned thoroughly
- B) Discussed openly
- C) Ignored or concealed
- D) Solved efficiently

✓ Answer: C — Ignored or concealed

Explanation:

Problems are hidden instead of being solved.

Q7.

To "steal someone's thunder" means to:

- A) Take revenge
- B) Copy an idea
- C) Take credit for another's achievement
- D) Interrupt angrily

 Answer: C — Take credit for another's achievement

Explanation:

Refers to taking attention or praise meant for someone else.

Q8.

The idiom "burn the midnight oil" means to:

- A) Waste resources
- B) Stay awake working late
- C) Cause pollution
- D) Celebrate at night

✔ Answer: B — Stay awake working late

Explanation:

Old reference to studying/working by oil lamps late at night.

Q9.

If someone "beats about the bush", he:

- A) Speaks aggressively
 - B) Avoids the main point
 - C) Argues logically
 - D) Is very direct
- ☒ Answer: B — Avoids the main point



Explanation:

Means speaking indirectly instead of addressing the issue directly.

Q10.

The phrase "in the doldrums" means:

- A) Extremely busy
 - B) In a depressed or inactive state
 - C) Highly motivated
 - D) Physically exhausted
- ☒ Answer: B — In a depressed or inactive state

Explanation:

Originally a sailing term for areas with no wind (no movement).



inactive
Doldrums

Q11.

To "take something with a pinch of salt" means to:

- A) Believe it completely
- B) Ignore it totally
- C) Accept it without doubt
- D) Be skeptical about it

✓ Answer: D — Be skeptical about it

Explanation:

Do not believe something completely; doubt its accuracy.

Q12.

The idiom "the ball is in your court" implies:

- A) You are under pressure
 - B) You have lost an opportunity
 - C) It is your turn to act. ✓
 - D) You are being judged
- ✓ Answer: C — It is your turn to act

Explanation:

From tennis—responsibility now lies with you.

Q13.

To "go out on a limb" means to:

- A) Act cautiously
- B) Take a risky stand ✓
- C) Escape responsibility
- D) Seek help

✓ Answer: B — Take a risky stand

Explanation:

Like sitting on a tree limb that may break.

Q14.

The phrase "once in a blue moon" refers to something that:

- A) Happens regularly
- B) Occurs unexpectedly
- C) Happens very rarely
- D) Happens at night

✓ Answer: C — Happens very rarely

Explanation:

A blue moon is an extremely rare astronomical event.

Q15.

If someone "hits the nail on the head", he:

- A) Makes a mistake
- B) Causes damage
- C) Says something irrelevant
- D) Says something exactly right

✔ Answer: D — Says something exactly right

Explanation:

Perfect accuracy in statement or judgment.

Q16.

To "add fuel to the fire" means to:

- A) Calm a situation
- B) Worsen an existing problem
- C) Solve a conflict
- D) Delay an argument

 Answer: B — Worsen an existing problem

Explanation:

Making a bad situation even worse.

Q17.

The idiom "by the skin of one's teeth" means:

- A) Easily and comfortably
 - B) Without effort
 - C) Barely or narrowly ✓
 - D) Accidentally
- ✓ Answer: C — Barely or narrowly

Explanation:

Escaping or succeeding by a very small margin.

Q18.

If someone "smells a rat", he:

- A) Finds a criminal
 - B) Notices something suspicious
 - C) Is frightened
 - D) Makes an error
- ✔ Answer: B — Notices something suspicious

Explanation:

Implies sensing deceit or foul play.

Q19.

The phrase "at loggerheads" means:

- A) Working together
 - B) In complete agreement
 - C) In serious disagreement
 - D) Under strict supervision
- ☒ Answer: C — In serious disagreement

Explanation:

Log = head → metaphor for heads clashing.

Q20.

To "call it a day" means to:

- A) Start a new task
 - B) Declare a holiday
 - C) End work or activity
 - D) Postpone a decision
- ✓ Answer: C — End work or activity

Explanation:

Decide to stop working, often after sufficient effort.



TCS NQT

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